



We explicitly wanted this home to feel like our cave, a safe space to completely unwind, while still being highly functional for hosting friends. Stepping through the wood-clad entrance door, you are greeted by a bespoke solid wood carved door handle that immediately anchors the cosy, intimate common space. To your right sits a cement-finished, arc-shaped dining nook paired with two loose chairs, set against a striking black-and-white tropical wallpaper by Kalaakari Haath.

This built-in seating allows us to efficiently utilise the odd corners of the room. A sage green bar cabinet acts as the sole large unit here, beautifully complemented by a solid, rough-cut stone pedestal coffee table. Immediately overlooking the dining area is our open-plan kitchen. We opted for a vibrant composition of bright marsala and black cabinets, a blue hand-glazed tiled dado, and custom-designed wooden handles.

Moving away from the sand-toned entry, the home progresses into a dusty pink lounge space. This room features a plush slipcover white sofa from Gulmohar Lane and a rotatable swing from my own furniture label, Pieces of Desire. To facilitate the perfect balance between working from home and entertaining, an island study desk anchors the room. Overhead, a custom-designed pulley lamp serves as a flexible centrepiece between the spaces, transitioning from a focused work light to ambient lighting. Hanging proudly above the sofa are two monochromatic paintings by Sri Lankan artist Krishan Kodithuwakku.

Every piece of furniture tells a local story; the TV ledge and the desk legs were meticulously hand-carved by local artisans from a village in Gujarat. We deliberately used obscure mood lighting and indirect lights to create engaging conversation starters as you walk through the apartment. To save visual space in the common area, we designed two massive, 12ft tall panelled sliding doors that sit flush in one plane. Inspired by bathos pinstripes, these orange and sand pinstripe doors smoothly slide open to reveal the hidden spaces behind them.

The first door leads into a dramatic powder toilet. It is designed with an inset red marble floor, a monolith basin, and dark IPS walls. The second door opens up into a guest bedroom that breaks away from conventional minimalism. It features a curved marsala red ceiling detailed with a stark black moulding and an intricately designed, sleek lighting system, giving the room the dramatic character of a modern household Moulin Rouge.

Finally, the master bedroom retreats into a warm, desert-toned sanctuary. We wrapped the space in taupe walls, maroon headboards, buttery sand-coloured sheers and full-length mauve and black wardrobes with emerald-toned handles. Underfoot, a honey and walnut-toned dual flooring creates an uber-dusky, cosy environment.

Every room maintains its individual identity, yet the overall warm undertones keep the home cohesive. Plants framing the windows catch the sea wind, filling our rooms with fresh rustling sounds. Ultimately, a home is where you lose your inhibitions with loved ones and build a life; this tiny footprint in the city is exactly our calm from the chaos.